

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 7
 ♥ K 6 5 3
 ♦ 7 6 2
 ♣ 10 5 4 3

♠ K Q 10 3

♥ A 4

♦ Q J 10 5

♣ A J 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 8 5 2
 ♥ J 10 9 8 2
 ♦ K 4
 ♣ 9 8

♠ J 6 4

♥ Q 7

♦ A 9 8 3

♣ K Q 7 6

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North

Your only hope is to win 8 more tricks before you lose the lead. That means the ♦ finesse had better work. At trick 2 you lead your ♦ Q, playing low from dummy if East doesn't cover. Repeat the finesse as necessary. When East has the ♦ K you will make your contract, and when West has the ♦ K you will go down. That's a 50% chance, just like most finesses. But remember, if you had tried to establish the ♠ suit instead of taking the finesse your chance of making 3NT would be 0%.

You can see what could have happened if you had tried to sneak even one ♠ trick. West would have grabbed the ♠ A and played a small ♥. East would have happily taken 4 ♥ tricks and you would be down 1.

You have a very solid 17 points and a balanced hand. You open 1NT. Partner responds 3NT and you pass.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♥ J. You hopefully put on the ♥ Q, but West plays the ♥ K.

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Winners: ♠ 0 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 4 : Total = 6

A hold-up won't help unless West had a doubleton ♥, giving East a 7-card suit. So you win your ♥ A. The ♠ suit is solid after the ♠ A is played, but before you could enjoy those 3 tricks the defenders would have really enjoyed a bunch of ♥s.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 6 3
 ♥ Q J 10 8 3
 ♦ J
 ♣ K J 6 2

♠ Q 10 9 8

♥ A 5

♦ 7 5 4 2

♣ 9 7 3



♠ J 7 5 4
 ♥ 9 6
 ♦ K Q 10 9
 ♣ Q 8 4

♠ A 2

♥ K 7 4 2

♦ A 8 6 3

♣ A 10 5

West	North	East	South
			1NT

All Pass

1NT by South
 entry to dummy you must save it until the right time.

Win the first trick with the ♥K. Then play ♠A followed by ♠2. Continue playing ♠s until the ♠K is forced out. Win whatever they play next and play your other winners. You cannot be stopped from taking 7 tricks.

Imagine what would have happened if you had taken the first trick with dummy's ♥A.

What would you try next? A ♠ finesse? Whether West took his ♠K right then or later you would go down. You could never reach dummy again.

You have 7 points so you know your side does not have a game. You also have no reason to think there is any better contract than 1NT. So you pass.

North would play 1NT. To make life more convenient the hands will be rotated so that South becomes declarer.

South plays 1NT. West leads the ♥Q.

South plays 1NT. West leads the ♥Q.

Winners: ♠ 1 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 5

You need two more winners. Even if the ♦s split 3-2 you can get only one more from that suit. So clearly you must use the ♠ suit. Since you have only one